

4.2 Mammalian reproduction

This section builds on the knowledge and understanding of cell division gained in Module 3 by introducing learners to the process of gametogenesis and its role in human reproduction. The hormonal regulation of both gametogenesis and the female reproductive cycle will be considered, as well as the part played by hormones in enabling natural conception to occur.

Learners will also gain an understanding of the treatments and procedures that have been developed by endocrinologists to assist conception, including IVF

and ICSI, and the issues that couples need to consider in order to make informed and ethical choices.

This section also considers the biological and ethical issues associated with infertility and the effects of ageing on the reproductive systems of men and women.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills gained in this section to new situations and/or to solve related problems.